Russia out of the Continental System in 1810. Two years later, Napoleon began marching towards Russia and while he was able to push back the Russians, the bitter cold winters crippled his forces. Napoleon withdrew so he could assemble a stronger force but the following year he was defeated by an alliance of European powers at the Battle of Leipzig.

In 1814, Napoleon fell into disgrace. He was exiled to Elba Island during the coronation of Louis XVIII. The new king was Bourbon, which meant that he was from the same dynastic line who had lost the throne two decades before. Just as Louis XVIII was arranging a new agreement with the other European powers, Napoleon fled Elba Island and returned to France to mobilize a new army. This period is referred to as the Hundred Days. In 1815, Napoleon faced Blucher and Wellington at Waterloo where he was defeated once more. He was exiled to Saint Helena and eventually died there.

By this time, Europe had suffered nearly twenty years of bloodshed and chaos. After Napoleon was defeated and exiled, Europe needed to be reconciled. A great meeting known as the Congress of Vienna was arranged between the European superpowers. Austria, Russia, France, Britain and Prussia met to negotiate for a peaceful and stable continent. The goal was to ensure that one country would not be able to overpower the others, just as France had done for many years. The Congress of Vienna was ultimately successful because the Europeans came to a mutual agreement amongst themselves.